

THE STORY SO FAR

- ▶ Lupin is the sixth-largest Indian pharma company by revenue, with record profits of ₹3,306 crore in FY25
- ▶ A decade of hard choices, from exiting Japan to refocusing its R&D and doubling down on complex generics, has helped the company turn around
- ▶ The balance sheet is net cash positive. R&D spend stands at

₹1,767 crore, roughly 8% of sales

- ▶ The US biosimilar pipeline targets launches from FY27, with 13 first-to-file products in hand
- ▶ The company's new moves include a GLP-1 anti-obesity licensing deal and acquisition of VISUfarma, a European eye care firm, for ₹190 mn



50

PER CENT

Revenue growth over five years

170

PER CENT

Profit growth over five years

₹1,767

CRORE

R&D spend FY25 (8% of sales)

tached your name to those businesses for a long time,” Nilesh says. “There are emotions involved and people involved. But continuing with something as a side activity is not right. If you want to do something, it has to be front and centre.”

By 2015, Lupin had grown into one of India's largest pharmaceutical companies by global sales and established a significant presence in the US generics market with revenues crossing \$2 billion. In 2016, looking to consolidate its position, Lupin acquired Gavis Pharmaceuticals, a New Jersey-based niche generics firm with a pipeline targeting a multi-billion dollar US market and 62 drug filings pending with the FDA. The deal gave Lupin its first US manufacturing footprint. But a regulatory crackdown on opioids in the US stalled the Gavis pipeline, and by 2018, Lupin had taken an impairment charge of ₹1,464 crore on the acquisition. The company then refocused on inhalation products, high-value generics and cost discipline, which set the stage for the recovery that came next.

The approach was consistent with the founding philosophy of making clear choices and going all in. Tuberculosis, India's biggest infectious killer, stood out starkly as a national priority. DBG made a counterintuitive decision to manufacture TB drugs end-to-end, starting with ethambutol. The decision paid off and Lupin went on to become the world's largest anti-TB drug manufacturer.

“One of the biggest early learnings was how a strong position was built in TB, an area that had tremendous unmet need,” Vinita says. Lupin was among the first to invest in manufacturing active pharmaceutical ingredients (API) for TB drugs such as rifampicin, which involves complex fermentation